

Word family: **office / offices / official / officially / officer**

Base word: office

Plural: offices

Related forms: official, officially, officer

Part of speech: noun(名詞) / adjective(相關形式) / adverb(相關形式)

Your phrase:

> “a packed train, a busy café, and a noisy **office**”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **office** means a workplace where people do administrative, professional, or business work, usually at desks or computers.

繁體中文: **供員工進行行政、專業或商業工作的辦公場所／辦公室**

中文翻譯:

> “a packed train, a busy café, and a noisy **office**”

「一列擠滿乘客的火車、一間繁忙的咖啡店，以及一個**嘈吵的辦公室／辦公場所**」

office = 供人處理行政、商業或專業工作的辦公空間

1. **office = workplace/room(辦公場所／房間) — 辦公室; 辦公場所**

This is the meaning in your original passage.

Meaning: A room or workplace where administrative, professional, or business work is done.

Practice 1 — Original

> “a packed train, a busy café, and a noisy **office**”

「一列擠滿乘客的火車、一間繁忙的咖啡店，以及一個**嘈吵的辦公室**。」

Practice 2

> “She works in a large **office** in the city centre.”

「她在市中心一個大型**辦公場所**工作。」

Practice 3

> “My **office** is on the fifth floor.”

「我的**辦公室**在五樓。」

office = 供人進行行政、商業或專業工作的房間或工作場所

2. **office = organization/administrative unit (機構／行政部門) — 辦事處; 辦公機構**

Meaning: An organization, department, or administrative unit that handles a particular type of work.

Practice 4

> “Please contact the admissions **office** for more information.”

「如需更多資料, 請聯絡招生**辦事處／行政部門**。」

Practice 5

> “The regional **office** handles customer complaints.”

「區域**辦事處**負責處理顧客投訴。」

office = 負責某項行政、管理或服務工作的機構／部門

Here, **office** does not necessarily mean one physical room.

3. **office = branch/location of an organization (機構的分部／辦事地點) — 分公司; 分部; 辦事處**

Meaning: A particular local branch or place from which an organization operates.

Practice 6

> “The company has **offices** in London and Singapore.”

「這家公司在倫敦和新加坡都設有**辦事處／分公司**。」

Practice 7

> “She transferred to the company’s New York **office**.”

「她調到公司的紐約**分部／辦事處**工作。」

office = 某機構在特定城市或地點設立的工作據點

This is closely related to #2, but the focus here is **location/branch**, not administrative function.

4. **office** = consulting premises of a professional (醫生／律師等專業人士的工作地點) — 診所; 事務所

Especially common in American English.

Practice 8

> “I have an appointment at the doctor’s **office**.”

「我預約了去醫生的**診所／診症室**。」

Practice 9

> “She called her lawyer’s **office**.”

「她打電話到律師的**事務所**。」

office = 醫生、律師等專業人士接待客戶或病人的工作場所

The natural Chinese translation changes by profession:

* **doctor’s office** → 診所／診症室

* **lawyer’s office** → 律師事務所

* **accountant’s office** → 會計師事務所

5. **office** = official position of authority (正式職位／公職) — 公職; 職位; 官職

This is a genuinely different meaning.

Meaning: An official position of authority or responsibility, especially in government or another institution.

Practice 10

> “She was elected to public **office**.”

「她當選擔任**公職**。」

Practice 11

> “He has held **office** for six years.”

「他已擔任這個**正式公職／職位**六年。」

office = 在政府或機構中具有正式權力和責任的職位

Common patterns:

* **hold office** = 擔任公職

* **run for office** = 競選公職

* **public office** = 公職

6. **take/enter/leave office** (正式職位的任期狀態) — 就職／上任／離任

These are fixed expressions built from sense #5.

Practice 12

> “The new president **took office** in January.”

「新總統在一月**正式就職／上任**。」

Practice 13

> “She **left office** at the end of her term.”

「她在任期結束時**離任**。」

take office = 正式開始擔任某個公職

leave office = 結束任期、不再擔任該職位

7. **term of office** (任職期間) — 任期

****Meaning:**** The period during which someone officially holds a particular position.

Practice 14

> “His ****term of office**** ends next year.”

「他的****任期****明年結束。」

Practice 15

> “During her ****term of office****, several reforms were introduced.”

「在她的****任職期間****，推出了多項改革。」

****term of office = 某人正式擔任某職位的整段期間****

8. ****office = staff/team supporting an important person (某官員／主管的幕僚團隊) — 辦公團隊; 幕僚／行政團隊****

****Meaning:**** The group of people who work for and support an important official or executive.

Practice 16

> “The mayor’s ****office**** issued a statement.”

「市長的****辦公團隊／辦公室****發表了一份聲明。」

Practice 17

> “Her ****office**** arranged the meeting.”

「她的****幕僚／行政團隊****安排了這次會議。」

****someone’s office = 為某位官員或主管提供行政、政策或日常支援的團隊****

Here, ****the mayor’s office**** may mean the ****staff and administrative unit****, not the physical room.

9. ****office hours (辦公／營業時段) — 辦公時間; 服務時間****

****Meaning:**** The hours during which an office or organization is normally open for business.

Practice 18

> “Our **office hours** are from nine to five.”

「我們的**辦公時間**是上午九時至下午五時。」

Practice 19

> “Please call during normal **office hours**.”

「請在正常**辦公時間**內致電。」

office hours = 機構正常辦公或提供服務的時段

10. **office hours** (教師／教授) — 教師指定接見學生的時間

Especially common in schools and universities.

Practice 20

> “You can ask the professor during her **office hours**.”

「你可以在教授的**指定學生諮詢時段**向她提問。」

Practice 21

> “I visited my tutor during **office hours**.”

「我在導師的**學生諮詢時間**去找他。」

office hours = 教師預先指定、讓學生前來提問或討論課業的時段

Same phrase, but a specialized academic use.

11. **home office** (家中工作空間) — 家庭辦公室; 家中工作區

Meaning: A room or area at home used for work.

Practice 22

> “She converted the spare bedroom into a **home office**.”

「她把客房改造成**家中的辦公室／工作區**。」

Practice 23

> “I need a quieter **home office** for video meetings.”

「我需要一個更安靜的**家庭辦公空間**來進行視像會議。」

home office = 家中專門用來工作或處理業務的空間

12. **box office** (戲院／電影業) — 售票處; 票房

This compound has two related meanings.

A. Physical ticket-sales place

> “We bought the tickets at the **box office**.”

「我們在**售票處**買了門票。」

B. Commercial ticket revenue/success

> “The film performed well at the **box office**.”

「這部電影的**票房表現很好**。」

box office = 售票處; 也可指電影或表演透過售票取得的商業收入／票房表現

13. **post office** (郵政服務場所) — 郵局

Practice 24

> “I need to go to the **post office** to send this parcel.”

「我要去**郵局**寄這個包裹。」

Practice 25

> “The nearest **post office** closes at five.”

「最近的**郵局**五時關門。」

post office = 提供郵寄、包裹及相關郵政服務的場所

This is not a new lexical meaning of **office**, but it is such a common family compound that it is worth including.

14. **official** = authorized/approved by an authority (正式授權／認可) — 官方的; 正式的

Now we move to the related adjective **official**.

Meaning: Formally approved, recognized, or issued by an authority or organization.

Practice 26

> “We are waiting for the **official** announcement.”

「我們正在等待**官方**正式發布的公告。」

Practice 27

> “The **official** results will be released tomorrow.”

「**正式結果**將於明天公布。」

official = 經有權力的機構正式批准、確認或發布的

15. **official** = relating to someone’s formal duties (正式職務) — 公務的; 職務上的

Meaning: Connected with someone’s recognized job or responsibilities.

Practice 28

> “The minister made an **official** visit to Japan.”

「部長對日本進行了一次**正式公務訪問**。」

Practice 29

> “She travelled there on **official** business.”

「她到那裡是為了處理**公務**。」

official = 與某人的正式職責、公務或職位有關的

16. **official** = person with authority/responsibility (官員／正式負責人) — 官員; 正式人員

Here, **official** is a noun.

Practice 30

> “Government **officials** attended the meeting.”

「多名政府**官員**出席了會議。」

Practice 31

> “An airport **official** checked the documents.”

「一名機場**工作人員／正式人員**檢查了文件。」

official = 在政府、機構或活動中擁有正式職責或權限的人

17. **officially** = in an authorized/formal way — 正式地; 官方地

Practice 32

> “The company **officially** launched the product today.”

「公司今天**正式**推出這項產品。」

Practice 33

> “The results have not been **officially** confirmed.”

「結果尚未獲得**官方正式確認**。」

officially = 以正式、獲授權或獲機構認可的方式

18. **officer = person holding an official position (機構中的正式職位人員) — 官員; 人員; 主任**

Meaning: A person holding a position of authority or responsibility in an organization.

Practice 34

> “She is the company’s compliance **officer**.”

「她是公司的合規**主任／負責人**。」

Practice 35

> “The safety **officer** inspected the building.”

「安全**主任**檢查了大樓。」

officer = 在機構內負責某項正式職能並具有相應責任或權限的人

Common examples:

* **police officer** = 警務人員

* **security officer** = 保安人員

* **compliance officer** = 合規主任

* **chief executive officer (CEO)** = 行政總裁

19. **officer = military/police rank-holder (軍警人員) — 軍官; 警官／警務人員**

Practice 36

> “A police **officer** spoke to the driver.”

「一名**警務人員**與司機交談。」

Practice 37

> “He served as an army **officer** for ten years.”

「他擔任**陸軍軍官**十年。」

****officer = 軍隊或警察等組織中具有正式職責和權限的人員****

Important distinction: **office vs workplace**

**office**

Usually a specific type of workplace where administrative/professional work is done.

**workplace**

Any place where someone works.

So:

* factory = workplace 

* restaurant = workplace 

* hospital = workplace 

* office = workplace 

But a factory is not normally an ****office****.

Important distinction: **office vs company**

**company**

= the business organization itself

**office**

= the place, branch, or administrative unit where its staff work

> “The company has an office in Tokyo.”

「這家公司在東京有一個辦事處。」

The ****company**** is the organization; the ****office**** is one operating location/unit.

Important distinction: **office vs department**

office

Can mean an administrative unit or branch.

department

Usually means a division responsible for a specific function.

> “the finance department”

> = 財務部

> “the regional office”

> = 區域辦事處

They may overlap in some organizations, but they are not automatically interchangeable.

Important distinction: **official vs officer**

Very important:

official

Can be:

* adjective → 官方的／正式的

* noun → 官員／正式人員

officer

Always refers to a person holding a formal role.

> “an **official** announcement”

> = 官方公告

> “a government **official**”

> = 政府官員

> “a police **officer**”

> = 警務人員

Important distinction: **office vs officer**

A very common learner error:

* **office** = 地方／機構／職位

* **officer** = 人

> “I went to the police **office**.”

> 可能指警察辦事處，但通常會說 **police station**。

> “I spoke to a police **officer**.”

> 「我跟一名警務人員交談。」

Family-extension note

Following your earlier point, these compounds are worth remembering because **office** remains visible inside them but the whole expression develops a specific practical meaning:

* **home office** = 家庭辦公室

* **head office** = 總公司／總部辦公室

* **branch office** = 分公司／分部辦事處

* **post office** = 郵局

* **box office** = 售票處／票房

* **office hours** = 辦公時間；教師諮詢時段

* **office worker** = 辦公室職員

* **office politics** = 辦公室內部的人際權力角力／職場政治

That last one is especially useful:

> “He tries to avoid **office politics**.”

「他盡量避開**辦公室內部的人際權力鬥爭和派系問題**。」

It is not simply “politics happening inside an office”; it refers to **informal competition, influence, alliances, and power struggles among colleagues**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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office — workplace	供人進行行政、商業或專業工作的房間或工作場所	
office — administrative unit	負責某項行政、管理或服務工作的辦事機構／部門	
office — branch	某機構在特定地點設立的工作據點或分部	
professional's office	醫生、律師等專業人士接待客戶或病人的工作場所	
office — position	在政府或機構中具有正式權力和責任的公職／職位	
take/leave office	正式開始擔任／結束擔任某個公職	
term of office	某人正式擔任某職位的任職期間	
someone's office	為某位官員或主管提供支援的行政／幕僚團隊	
office hours — business	機構正常辦公或提供服務的時段	
office hours — academic	教師指定讓學生前來諮詢或討論課業的時段	
home office	家中專門用來工作的辦公空間	
box office	售票處;亦可指電影／表演的票房收入表現	
post office	提供郵政及包裹服務的郵局	
official — authorized	經有權機構正式批准、確認或發布的	
official — duties	與某人的正式職責或公務有關的	
official — person	在政府或機構中擁有正式職責或權限的人	
officially	以正式、獲授權或獲機構認可的方式	
officer	在組織中負責正式職能並具有相應責任或權限的人	
office politics	職場內部涉及影響力、派系、人際競爭和權力的非正式角力	

For your original phrase

> “a packed train, a busy café, and a noisy ****office****”

The exact meaning is:

****office** = 供員工進行行政、專業或商業工作的辦公場所

So:

****a noisy office** = 一個有大量談話聲、電話聲、鍵盤聲或設備聲, 令人容易受到干擾的辦公室／辦公環境